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Grade 11 Geography

2. 🌍 Factors Affecting Development

Learning Guide

🧠 1. Overview

Development is influenced by a combination of:

- **Economic factors**
- **Social factors**
- **Environmental factors**
- **Community participation**

These factors can either **support development** or **slow it down**, depending on how they are managed.

📌 ***Key idea:*** *Development does not depend on one factor only. Economic, social and environmental conditions all work together.*

💰 2. Economic Factors of Development

Economic factors affect how well a country can produce, invest, create jobs and improve living standards.

Infrastructure

- Infrastructure is necessary for **economic activities and growth**.
- It provides the basic systems needed for development.

📌 ***Key idea:*** *Good infrastructure makes economic activity easier and supports growth.*

Investment

- Investment provides money to:
  - Fund development projects.
  - Expand economic activities.
  - Create jobs.

📌 ***Key idea:*** *More investment can increase development and employment.*

Economic Policies

- Economic policies help create a **conducive environment for growth**.
- They influence how businesses, investment and economic activities operate.

Technology

- Technology increases:
  - **Productivity**
  - **Innovation**
- It can make production faster and more efficient.

📌 ***Key idea:*** *Better technology can increase the amount and quality of goods and services produced.*

Natural Resources

- Natural resources can either:
  - **Drive development**
  - Or **hinder development**
- The result depends on how well the resources are managed.

📌 ***Key idea:*** *Having resources is not enough; they must also be managed properly.*

Trade

- Trade encourages economic growth by giving countries access to **markets**.
- Businesses can sell goods and services to a wider group of consumers.

Labour Market Conditions

- Labour market conditions affect:
  - Employment.

    - Economic stability.
- A functioning labour market helps people find work and supports economic activity.

Financial Systems

- Financial systems help:
    - Facilitate investment.
    - Support economic activities.
- They make it easier for money to move through the economy.

Government Spending

- Government spending supports:
    - Infrastructure.
    - Public services.
- This can improve economic and social development.

Entrepreneurship

- Entrepreneurship encourages:
    - **Economic diversification**
    - **Innovation**
- New businesses can introduce new products, services and employment opportunities.

👥 3. Social Factors of Development

Social conditions strongly influence the productivity and quality of life of a population.

Education

- Education provides people with:
    - Skills.
    - Knowledge.
- These are essential for **economic growth**.

📌 **Key idea:** A better educated population can contribute more effectively to development.

Healthcare

- Healthcare affects:
    - Overall well-being.
    - Productivity.
- Healthier people are generally better able to work and participate in the economy.

Social Stability

- Social stability creates a **safe environment**.
- This encourages:
    - Investment.
    - Economic growth.

Cultural Attitudes

- Cultural attitudes can influence:
    - Work ethics.
    - Entrepreneurship.
    - Gender roles.

Population Growth

- Population growth affects:
    - Resource allocation.
    - Size of the workforce.

📌 **Key idea:** Population growth can increase the labour supply, but it also increases demand for resources and services.

Gender Equality

- Equal opportunities can improve productivity.
- When more people are able to participate in development, the economy can benefit.

Social Services

- Social services help reduce:
    - Poverty.
    - Inequality.

Crime Rates

- Lower crime creates a safer environment for:
    - Businesses.
    - Workers.
    - Economic activity.

Community Engagement

- Community engagement helps drive **local development initiatives**.
- People become involved in decisions and activities that affect their area.

Migration

- Migration affects:
    - Labour markets.
    - Distribution of resources.

🌱 4. Environmental Factors of Development

The environment can either support or limit development.

Climate Change

- Climate change affects:
    - Agriculture.
    - Living conditions.

Natural Disasters

- Natural disasters can slow development by:
    - Damaging infrastructure.
    - Destroying property and productive land.

📌 ***Key idea:*** *Disasters may force countries to spend money on repairs instead of new development.*

Environmental Policies

- Good environmental policies promote **sustainable development**.
- They help control how natural resources are used.

Biodiversity

- Biodiversity supports activities such as:
    - Agriculture.
    - Tourism.

Pollution

- Pollution:
    - Harms health.
    - Can discourage investment.

Resource Depletion

- The overuse of resources can create **long-term economic challenges**.
- Development becomes difficult if essential resources are exhausted.

Land Use

- Land use is important for:
    - Sustainable agriculture.
    - Industry.

Water Availability

- Water is essential for:
    - Health.
    - Industry.

📌 ***Key idea:*** *Limited water availability can restrict both human well-being and economic development.*

Air Quality

- Better air quality contributes to:
    - Better health.
    - Higher quality of life.

Waste Management

- Proper waste management:

- Reduces pollution.
- Supports sustainability.

🏘️ 5. Community-Based Development (CBD)

- **Community-based development** is an approach that emphasises the **active participation and leadership of community members**.
- Community members take part in:
  - Planning.
  - Implementing.
  - Managing projects.
- These projects directly affect their lives.

Main Purpose

- To **empower local communities** so that they can:
  - Identify their own needs.
  - Mobilise resources.
  - Create sustainable solutions.

📌 **Key idea:**

CBD means development is done **with communities**, not simply **for communities**.

🤝 6. Key Aspects of Community-Based Development

1. Local Participation

- Community members take part in **decision-making**.
- This helps ensure that projects reflect:
  - Their needs.
  - Their priorities.

2. Empowerment

- Builds the capacity of people and groups.
- Helps communities take control of their **own development**.
- Can improve quality of life.

3. Sustainability

- Encourages the use of:
  - Local resources.
  - Local knowledge.
- This helps create **long-lasting outcomes**.

4. Collaboration

- Encourages partnerships between:
  - Community members.
  - Local organisations.
  - External agencies.
- Partnerships help combine:
  - Resources.
  - Skills.
  - Expertise.

5. Holistic Approach

- Community development addresses several linked areas:
  - Economic.
  - Social.
  - Environmental.

📌 ***Key idea:*** *Development problems are connected, so they should not always be treated separately.*

6. Ownership

- Communities develop a sense of ownership over projects.
- This encourages:
  - Better maintenance.

- Greater sustainability of outcomes.

🔄 7. How the Main Factors Connect

Factor	How It Supports Development
Infrastructure	Makes economic activity easier
Investment	Funds projects and creates jobs
Technology	Improves productivity and innovation
Education	Builds skills and knowledge
Healthcare	Improves well-being and productivity
Social stability	Encourages investment
Water availability	Supports health and industry
Environmental policies	Promote sustainable development
Community participation	Ensures projects match local needs
Ownership	Improves maintenance and long-term success

🧠 8. Final Exam Summary

- Development is affected by **economic, social and environmental factors**.
- Important **economic factors** include:
  - Infrastructure.
  - Investment.
  - Economic policies.
  - Technology.
  - Natural resources.
  - Trade.
  - Labour market conditions.
  - Financial systems.
  - Government spending.
  - Entrepreneurship.
- Important **social factors** include:
  - Education.
  - Healthcare.
  - Social stability.
  - Cultural attitudes.
  - Population growth.
  - Gender equality.
  - Social services.
  - Crime.
  - Community engagement.
  - Migration.
- Important **environmental factors** include:
  - Climate change.
  - Natural disasters.
  - Environmental policies.
  - Biodiversity.
  - Pollution.
  - Resource depletion.
  - Land use.
  - Water availability.
  - Air quality.
  - Waste management.
- **Community-based development** involves communities actively participating in their own development.
- Main CBD principles:
  - Local participation.
  - Empowerment.
  - Sustainability.
  - Collaboration.
  - Holistic approach.
  - Ownership.

📌 **Core idea:**
Successful development depends on strong economic conditions, healthy and skilled communities, responsible environmental management, and active local participation.

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